

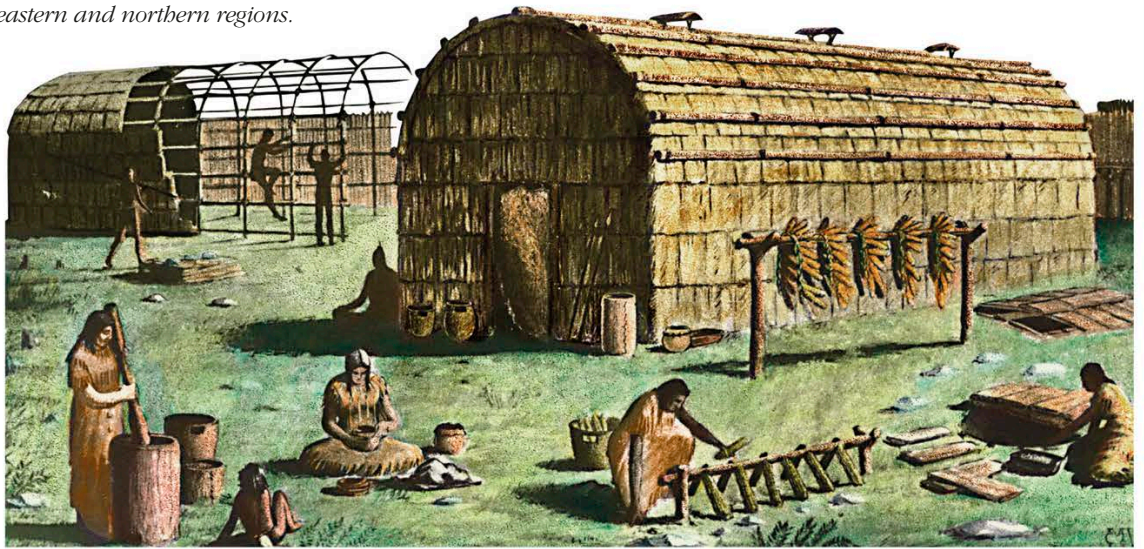


▲ DISTRIBUTION OF COMMUNITIES

Prehistoric farming and mound-building communities were spread out across North America. The Ancestral Puebloans and other farming communities such as the Hohokam and Mogollon people lived in the southwest, while the Mississippians built their communities around large earthen mounds in the eastern and northern regions.

IROQUOIS ►

The Great Lakes of North America were settled by Iroquois nations in the mid-15th century. Their village homes, called longhouses, were built next to the water for canoeing and fishing. Longhouses were made of wood covered in elm bark. There was a door at both ends and a hole in the roof to let out smoke from fires lit for warmth and cooking.



ARCTIC PEOPLE ▼

The Thule people lived in the Arctic regions of North America from about 1000 CE. They survived the freezing conditions by wearing clothes made from animal fur and building homes with animal bones and skins. They were skilled hunters, targeting walruses, whales, and seals using handcrafted harpoons and slate knives.

Sledge made of seal bones and skin



500-1450

MISSISSIPPIAN CRAFTS

Early pottery from Mississippian communities was plain and practical, with pots and jars that proved useful for storing crops and carrying water. As potters and sculptors became more skilled, they created elaborate designs. Decorative pieces included shells, pipes, crockery, and clay heads made as offerings to the dead.



CARVED SHELL



CEREMONIAL VESSEL



FROG-SHAPED PIPE



▲ MISSISSIPPIAN CULTURE

The people of the Mississippian culture were farmers who grew crops such as maize and beans. They built houses and other buildings on large earth mounds in the Mississippi Valley. The mound city of Cahokia (above) near the modern-day city of St. Louis, Missouri, was once home to thousands of people.